CROSS-BORDER NOTES

On August 7, an Uzbek bank went on state television and announced it is converting to Islamic finance.

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MKBANK paired the announcement with domestic retail promotions. That pairing is the tell.

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Gulf capital lands where the plumbing already exists. No sukuk desk, no murabaha structuring, no Islamic window: no serious GCC allocation.

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Regulatory intent precedes capital. If Tashkent normalizes Islamic finance at the bank level, sovereign issuance tends to follow.

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Central Asian banks are doing the compliance work Gulf capital requires, before any Gulf institution has to ask.

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> **Whoever converts first sets the terms for the capital that follows. Read it like a central bank circular, not a press release.**

Sun Choi
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